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UPSC Intel · Daily Brief

TUESDAY, 06 OCTOBER 2026

17 must-know stories, 20 Prelims facts, 15 editorials and 19 explainers, picked from 895 stories reported. Each item links to its source; notes quote the reports.

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MUST-KNOW

High-yield stories: make notes on these. Grouped by syllabus area.

Polity & Constitution

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Watch: Supreme Court's verdict on Preamble of the Constitution

The Supreme Court rejected a plea seeking directions to make recitation of the Preamble mandatory in morning assemblies across all schools. The bench comprising Justices Vikram Nath, Sandeep Mehta and AG Masih declined to interfere and dismissed the petition. The petitioner argued that reciting the Preamble would help students understand and imbibe constitutional values and principles. The Supreme Court refused to issue a judicial mandate, meaning schools are not legally required to recite the Preamble. The ruling comes amid recurring demands for greater constitutional awareness among schoolchildren through educational activities. Separately, the Supreme Court upheld the inclusion of the words 'socialist' and 'secular' in the Preamble via the 42nd Amendment of 1976.

When: 2026-10-06 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Justices Vikram Nath, Sandeep Mehta and AG Masih · **Prelims:** The petition was heard by Justices Vikram Nath, Sandeep Mehta and AG Masih.; The 42nd Constitutional Amendment in 1976 added 'socialist' and 'secular' to the Preamble.; The Preamble sets out the objectives of justice, liberty, equality and fraternity.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Clarifies the limits of judicial mandates in educational institution routines and administrative policy matters.; Reinforces the constitutional validity of the 42nd Amendment incorporating 'socialist' and 'secular' into the Preamble.*

Static — The Preamble is based on the Objective Resolution introduced by Jawaharlal Nehru in the Constituent Assembly on December 13, 1946. It declares India to be a Sovereign, Socialist, Secular, Democratic, and Republic nation, securing justice, liberty, equality, and fraternity. The 42nd Constitutional Amendment Act of 1976 added the words 'Socialist', 'Secular', and 'Integrity' to the Preamble.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment, Act/Bill/Rules

The Hindu: read the source · *free copy on newsx.com*

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Did not clear Form 6 change… can annul unilateral decisions: Supreme Court sends notice to Election Commission

The Supreme Court stated it will examine all decisions of the Election Commission and annul any found not to be in accordance with law. The bench issued notices to the Centre and the poll body on pleas alleging that the CEC took several decisions without the approval of the two election commissioners. The core issue involves allegations that Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar unilaterally modified Form 6 during the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls without majority consensus. A bench headed by CJI Surya Kant made it clear that any modifications to Form 6 had not been approved by the court. The Supreme Court refused to pass an interim direction to restrain or suspend CEC Gyanesh Kumar from taking decisions before hearing responses from the EC and Centre. Election Commission officials maintained that Form 6 was not changed, but a declaration was attached to it during the Bihar SIR order of June 24, 2025. Opposition parties including the INDIA bloc demanded the immediate resignation and removal of the CEC over the controversy.

When: 2026-10-06 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, CEC Gyanesh Kumar, Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi, Petitioner Rakesh Kumar Singh · **Prelims:** Form 6 is the application form used by eligible persons to seek inclusion in the electoral rolls.; The bench hearing the case was headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant.; The Chief Election Commissioner mentioned in the reports is Gyanesh Kumar.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights crucial questions regarding decision-making authority, consensus, and institutional integrity within multi-member constitutional bodies.; Examines the statutory scope of executive powers exercised by the Chief Election Commissioner versus the Commission as a collective entity.*

Static — The Election Commission of India is an autonomous constitutional body established under Article 324 of the Constitution on January 25, 1950, to conduct elections to Parliament, State Legislatures, and the offices of President and Vice-President. Originally a single-member body, the Election Commission became a multi-member body in 1989 with the appointment of additional Election Commissioners. The Chief Election Commissioner and Election Commissioners are appointed by the President and hold office for a term of six years or until they attain the age of 65

years, whichever is earlier.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

ptinews.com: read the source · also reported by Times of India, Vajiram & Ravi, India Today

Governance & Policy

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Ministry of Rural Development Notifies 375 Permissible Works under VB–G RAM G

The Centre notified 375 permissible works under the new rural employment framework called the VB-G RAM G Act, 2025. This list represents a 41 percent expansion over the 266 works allowed under the previous scheme. The expansion places greater emphasis on livelihood infrastructure, water security, and disaster preparedness. The 375 works are divided into four categories: water security, core rural infrastructure, livelihood-related infrastructure, and disaster preparedness. Water security has the highest share with 128 works, followed by 111 in core infrastructure, 98 in livelihood infrastructure, and 38 in disaster preparedness. Livelihood-related works account for 26 per cent of the total, up from 1.1 per cent in the previous framework, including agro-processing units, mini flour mills, and dairy infrastructure. The framework includes 181 works related to agriculture and allied activities, 107 for Antyodaya households, and 36 each for women and youth. Works are planned through Viksit Gram Panchayat Plans, approved by the Gram Sabha, and tracked via the Viksit Bharat National Rural Infrastructure Stack. The VB-G RAM G Act came into force on July 1, replacing MGNREGA to provide 125 days of guaranteed wage employment per rural household annually.

When: October 6, 2026 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Ministry of Rural Development · **Prelims:** The VB-G RAM G Act, 2025 came into force on July 1.; The new schedule includes 375 permissible works across four categories.; Water security comprises 128 works, the highest among all categories.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Expands rural employment works to 375 categories, significantly increasing the focus on livelihood-generating assets and agricultural productivity.; Introduces a dedicated disaster preparedness category to build resilience against extreme weather events in rural areas.*

Static — The Viksit Bharat Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (VB-G RAM G) Gramin Act, 2025, replaced the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA). The Act provides for 125 days of guaranteed wage employment per rural household annually, compared to 100 days under MGNREGA. It introduces a 60:40 Centre-state funding ratio for most states, with the Centre determining normative allocations and states bearing expenditure beyond those limits.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Governance & Policy, Polity & Constitution, Economy · Prelims angle: Scheme, Act/Bill/Rules

PIB: read the source · free copy on ptinews.com · also reported by Business Standard

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Cabinet approves new body to integrate transport and logistics planning

The Union Cabinet approved the creation of a Special Purpose Vehicle named the Integrated Transport & Logistics Authority (ITLA). The body was approved to address long-standing challenges of fragmented planning and implementation across multiple transport-related ministries and agencies. ITLA will function as the apex body for integrated transport and logistics planning, research, project appraisal, monitoring, policy support, and data analytics. It will prepare a comprehensive National Transport Master Plan with a planning horizon of ten years or more across various transport sectors. ITLA will evaluate short-term sectoral plans and annual plans of transport ministries to ensure consistency and promote multi-modal infrastructure development. It will undertake technical appraisal and monitor implementation of central infrastructure projects costing Rs.500 crore or more, alongside issue resolution. ITLA will build a unified transport data repository using sources like GSTN e-way bill, FASTag, Vahan, and GPS-based systems for analytics. The establishment of ITLA aims to help realize India’s Vision 2047 by strengthening multimodal connectivity and reducing logistics costs.

When: 2026-10-06 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Union Cabinet, Prime Minister Narendra Modi · **Prelims:** ITLA stands for Integrated Transport & Logistics Authority.; ITLA will undertake technical appraisal of infrastructure projects of the Government of India costing Rs.500 crore or more.; ITLA will build a unified transport data repository using datasets like GSTN e-way bill, FASTag, and Vahan.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Helps overcome fragmented planning and implementation across different transport ministries.; Aims to reduce India's logistics costs and improve global logistics competitiveness.*

Static — Special Purpose Vehicles (SPVs) are distinct legal entities created by a government or parent organization for a specific, narrow, and temporary or permanent objective. Multi-modal logistics involves the integration of multiple modes of transport—such as roads, railways, air, and shipping—under a single unified network. Infrastructure project appraisal involves assessing the technical, economic, financial, and environmental viability of capital-intensive public projects before approval.

Syllabus: GS3: Governance & Policy, Economy

Business Standard: read the source · free copy on msn.com · also reported by Economic Times, Times of India, PIB, Inshorts

International Relations

GS2 MAKE NOTES

India, Switzerland sign key agreements on visas, defence and technology

India and Switzerland signed five pacts following talks between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Swiss President Guy Parmelin at Hyderabad House. The signed agreements cover migration and mobility, young professional exchanges, transport, scientific research, and innovation and technology transfer. The core issue focuses on expanding bilateral cooperation, improving market access for Indian exports, and boosting infrastructure and defence investments. The MoU on Migration and Mobility Partnership aims to combat irregular migration and provides multiple-entry visas for up to five years. The Agreement on the Exchange of Young Professionals allows temporary employment for 300 persons annually per country, which may increase to 500. The transport pact includes cooperation in electric vehicles, ropeways, circular economy, tunnels, and infrastructure development. Both leaders noted that the Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement between India and EFTA countries came into force in October of the previous year. The leaders also agreed to deepen cooperation in nuclear energy, launch joint research projects, and host the Prosperity Summit with EFTA business leaders.

When: 2026-10-06 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Swiss President Guy Parmelin · **Prelims:** India and Switzerland signed five pacts during the visit of Swiss President Guy Parmelin.; The Young Professionals Agreement covers an exchange of 300 persons annually per country, expandable to 500.; The EFTA economic bloc includes Switzerland, Iceland, Liechtenstein, and Norway.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Opens up new opportunities for Indian students, researchers, and professionals in Switzerland through streamlined mobility pacts.; Enhances bilateral trade and investment, targeting large-scale Swiss investments in Indian infrastructure and manufacturing sectors.*

Static — Switzerland is a landlocked federal republic in Central Europe, known for its neutrality, federal governance, and status as a major global financial and diplomatic hub. The European Free Trade Association is an intergovernmental trade organization comprising Iceland, Liechtenstein, Norway, and Switzerland, established to promote free trade. Bilateral relations between India and Switzerland are anchored by a Treaty of Friendship signed in August 1948, shortly after India's independence.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations, Defence · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU

deccanchronicle.com: read the source · also reported by Indian Express, Ministry of External Affairs

Health

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Serum Institute’s HPV vaccine Cervavac receives WHO prequalification

Cervavac, India's first indigenously developed gender-neutral quadrivalent Human Papillomavirus vaccine, received World Health Organization prequalification. The recognition was granted because WHO prequalification acts as a quality assessment process enabling procurement by UN agencies and international public health programmes. The core debate centers around expanding global access to affordable vaccines and enhancing India's presence in the global vaccine supply chain. The vaccine was developed by the Serum Institute of India located in Pune. It specifically targets HPV types 6, 11, 16, and 18 to prevent HPV-related cancers and genital warts. The vaccine is indicated for individuals aged nine through 26 years, covering both girls and boys. Development involved collaboration with the Department of Biotechnology, BIRAC, WHO IARC, and the Bill & Melinda Gates Foundation. It received approval from the Drugs Controller General of India and was launched nationally on January 24, 2023. This marks the 32nd WHO prequalification received by the Serum Institute of India for its biological products.

When: 24 January 2023 · **Where:** Pune, Maharashtra · **Who:** Serum Institute of India, World Health Organization, Drugs Controller General of India · **Prelims:** Cervavac targets HPV types 6, 11, 16, and 18.; It is indicated for girls and boys aged nine through 26 years.; The vaccine was launched nationally in India on 24 January 2023.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Allows international public health programmes and UN agencies to procure Cervavac for global distribution.; Reinforces India's manufacturing capability and expands its footprint in the global vaccine supply chain.*

Static — Human Papillomavirus (HPV) is a viral infection that commonly causes skin warts and is directly linked to several types of cancers, notably cervical cancer. HPV types 16 and 18 are high-risk strains responsible for the majority of HPV-related cervical and other anogenital cancers. HPV types 6 and 11 are low-risk strains primarily responsible for the development of benign genital warts.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Health

The Hindu: read the source · free copy on gktoday.in

Economy

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Cabinet approves Commitment of Rs.10,000 Crore towards establishment of the SME Growth Fund for direct equity investments in Small and Medium Enterprises to create future champions

The Union Cabinet approved the Government of India's commitment of Rs 10,000 crore to establish the SME Growth Fund (SGF). The fund was announced as part of Para 28 of the Union Budget 2026-27 to strengthen the MSME ecosystem through equity and liquidity support. Most existing equity funds focus on early-stage micro enterprises, leaving a structural gap in growth-stage capital for small and medium enterprises. The initiative supports the Viksit Bharat 2047 vision by deepening domestic capital markets and building globally competitive Indian companies. SMEs are vital economic backbones, significantly contributing to employment generation, manufacturing output, innovation, and exports. The SGF bridges the financing gap for long-term risk capital needed by SMEs to scale, innovate, and expand internationally. A majority of the SGF allocation will be directed toward small and medium manufacturing enterprises, including those in Tier-II and Tier-III industrial clusters. The funds will be channeled through an Alternative Investment Fund (AIF) established under the SGF framework to provide patient growth equity.

When: 2026-10-06 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Union Cabinet · **Prelims:** The Government commitment to the SME Growth Fund is Rs 10,000 crore.; Small enterprises have an investment limit of up to Rs. 25 crore and turnover of up to Rs. 100 crore.; Medium enterprises have an investment limit of up to Rs. 125 crore and turnover of up to Rs. 500 crore.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Provides patient growth equity to high-potential SMEs to help them scale operations and adopt advanced technologies.; Promotes balanced regional industrial development by supporting industrial clusters in Tier-II and Tier-III cities.*

Static — Alternative Investment Funds (AIFs) are privately pooled investment vehicles established in India that collect funds from sophisticated investors for investing in accordance with a defined investment policy. MSMEs are classified based on investment in plant and machinery or equipment and annual turnover, with small enterprises having investment up to Rs. 25 crore and turnover up to Rs. 100 crore. Medium enterprises are defined as having an investment of up to Rs. 125 crore and an annual turnover of up to Rs. 500 crore.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Governance & Policy, Disaster Management · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

Economic Times: read the source · free copy on msn.com · also reported by CNBC TV18, The Hindu, Business Today, Fibre2Fashion

GS3 MAKE NOTES

RBI set for first rate hike in almost four years as rupee, inflation weigh

The Reserve Bank of India announced its latest monetary policy decision, raising the repo rate by 25 basis points to 5.5% from 5.25%. The central bank changed its policy stance from neutral to calibrated tightening due to pressures from the rupee and inflation. A majority of economists surveyed by Bloomberg expected the six-member Monetary Policy Committee to implement this rate hike. This move marks the first such rate hike under Governor Sanjay Malhotra in almost four years. The repo rate is the annualised interest rate at which the RBI lends money to commercial banks against government securities. An increase in the repo rate influences borrowing and liquidity conditions, which can lead to higher loan EMIs for ordinary consumers.

When: 2026-10-06 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Reserve Bank of India, Governor Sanjay Malhotra, Monetary Policy Committee · **Prelims:** The repo rate was raised by 25 basis points to 5.5% from 5.25%.; The policy stance was changed from neutral to calibrated tightening.; The Monetary Policy Committee has six members.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Signals a shift in monetary policy towards tightening to combat inflation and currency depreciation.; Increases the cost of funds for banks, which typically translates into higher loan EMIs for consumers.*

Static — The Monetary Policy Committee is a statutory body under the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934, responsible for fixing the benchmark policy interest rate. The MPC comprises six members: three officials of the RBI and three external members appointed by the central government. The repo rate is a short-term, collateralised borrowing arrangement where commercial banks sell securities to the RBI and agree to repurchase them.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy · Prelims angle: Data/Stats, Report/Index

Business Standard: read the source · free copy on hindustantimes.com · also reported by Moneycontrol.com, CNBC TV18

GS3 MAKE NOTES

World Bank ups India’s growth to 7.1% in FY27

The World Bank raised its forecast for India's GDP growth in the current financial year to 7.1 per cent, up from 6.6 per cent in April. This upward revision follows a stronger-than-expected economic expansion of 7.8 per cent in the first quarter of FY27. Private consumption and investment supported the strong Q1 growth and are expected to remain the main growth drivers. Public investment, supportive financial and policy conditions, and better-than-expected exports are projected to provide further upside. Industrial activity exceeded expectations with strong growth in infrastructure goods, construction goods, and electricity generation. A rainfall deficit during the southwest monsoon weakened agricultural prospects and may moderately affect rural demand. Elevated global trade and geopolitical uncertainties, along with oil prices and climate challenges like El Nino, pose external risks to the outlook.

When: 2026-10-06 · **Where:** India · **Who:** World Bank · **Prelims:** World Bank revised India's FY27 growth forecast to 7.1 per cent.; India's economy expanded by 7.8 per cent in the first quarter of FY27.; Private consumption and investment are noted as the main growth drivers.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reflects strong macroeconomic fundamentals and domestic resilience despite global uncertainties.; Highlights the critical role of private consumption and industrial activity in driving India's economy.*

Static — The World Bank is an international financial institution that provides loans and grants to the governments of low- and middle-income countries for capital projects. Established in 1944 at the Bretton Woods Conference, the World Bank is headquartered in Washington, D.C., United States. It comprises two main institutions: the International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD) and the International Development Association (IDA).

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, International Relations, Science & Technology · Prelims angle: Data/Stats, Report/Index

BusinessLine: read the source · free copy on newsonair.gov.in · also reported by finance.biggo.com

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Centre plans faceless CGST scheme in 3-4 months, seeks to cut taxpayer-officer interface

The Finance Ministry plans to launch a faceless scheme for Central Goods and Services Tax on a trial basis in three to four months. The primary trigger is to eliminate physical interaction between taxpayers and individual tax officers to enhance transparency and efficiency. Under the new framework, cases will be assigned randomly using artificial intelligence and data analytics to specialized teams instead of local officers. The proposed design draws inspiration from the existing faceless assessment framework currently utilized by the Income Tax Department. This move aims to curb the discretion of individual jurisdictional officers and reduce direct taxpayer-officer contact during scrutiny proceedings. The upcoming GST Council meeting on October 8 is also expected to review reforms concerning registration, refunds, and returns. In May 2023, the CBIC previously rolled out an Automated Return Scrutiny Module for risk-based electronic return selection and communication. Specific details regarding which initial CGST proceedings will be included in the pilot remain to be specified by authorities.

When: 2026-10-06 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Finance Ministry, CBIC, GST Council · **Prelims:** The faceless CGST scheme trial is planned to start in 3 to 4 months.; The CBIC rolled out an Automated Return Scrutiny Module in May 2023.; The GST Council is scheduled to meet on October 8.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reduces individual officer discretion and potential corruption by replacing local jurisdiction with random, automated case allocation.; Improves transparency, efficiency, and accountability in central tax administration for businesses.*

Static — The Goods and Services Tax (GST) is an indirect tax introduced in India via the 101st Constitutional Amendment Act, 2016, subsuming multiple central and state taxes. The GST Council is a constitutional body established under Article 279A, chaired by the Union Finance Minister and comprising state finance ministers. The Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs (CBIC) is a part of the Department of Revenue under the Ministry of Finance, responsible for administering GST and customs.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Economy, Governance & Policy, Science & Technology · Prelims angle: Scheme

Economic Times: read the source · free copy on news.webindia123.com

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Centre to propose five-pronged reform plan at GST Council meeting on October 8

The 57th GST Council meeting has been rescheduled to October 8 due to unavoidable circumstances. The meeting will be chaired by Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman and includes representatives from the Centre and states. The Centre is set to propose a five-pronged reform plan covering process reforms, structural reforms, ease of living and doing business, service exports, and e-commerce. Proposals include changes to registration, returns, refunds, dispute resolution, and improving input tax credit flow to reduce compliance costs. Recommendations stem from the GST Council's Law Committee, aiming to simplify laws and distinguish intentional tax evasion from unintentional failures. Discussions will also cover compliance easing measures for e-commerce suppliers under the current GST framework. Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Finance Minister Sitharaman have both emphasized that the next phase of reforms will boost business confidence and investment. The meeting was initially scheduled for September 12, postponed due to the BRICS summit, and later shifted from October 7 to October 8.

When: October 8, 2026 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Nirmala Sitharaman, GST Council Secretariat, Law Committee · **Prelims:** The 57th GST Council meeting is chaired by Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman.; The five-pronged reform plan covers process reforms, structural reforms, ease of living and doing business, exports of services, and e-commerce.; Section 69 of the Central GST Act empowers the Commissioner to authorise arrests for specified offences under Section 132.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Aims to significantly reduce time and cost of tax compliance for businesses and taxpayers.; Seeks to distinguish unintentional errors from deliberate tax evasion, protecting genuine taxpayers.*

Static — The Goods and Services Tax Council is a constitutional body established under Article 279A of the Constitution of India, introduced by the 101st Constitutional Amendment Act, 2016. The Council is chaired by the Union Finance Minister and includes the Union Minister of State in charge of Revenue or Finance and the Minister-in-charge of Finance or Taxation of every state. The GST Council makes recommendations to the Union and the States on important issues related to GST, such as tax rates, exemptions, thresholds, and dispute resolution.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Economy

The Hindu: read the source · free copy on zeenews.india.com

GS3 MAKE NOTES

RBI Governor to Announce Monetary Policy Committee Decisions at 10 AM on Wednesday

The Reserve Bank of India will announce its bi-monthly monetary policy decision on Wednesday after a three-day Monetary Policy Committee meeting. Several experts expect a repo rate hike after nearly three and a half years due to rising inflation pressures from the West Asia conflict. Reserve Bank Governor Sanjay Malhotra will announce the rate decision at 10 AM. A potential rate hike would mark a stance reversal following four rate cuts totalling 125 basis points in 2025 and a prolonged pause. The last repo rate hike occurred in February 2023 when the rate was raised by 0.25 per cent to 6.50 per cent. Currently, the RBI policy repo rate stands at 5.25 per cent. A majority of PTI poll participants expect a 25 basis points rate hike with a hawkish tone, while opinions remain divided on stance shift. India's retail inflation based on the consumer price index accelerated to 4.82 per cent in August from 4.45 per cent in July.

When: 2026-10-06 · **Where:** Mumbai · **Who:** Sanjay Malhotra, Reserve Bank Governor · **Prelims:** Current policy repo rate stands at 5.25 per cent.; Retail inflation accelerated to 4.82 per cent in August.; Last repo rate hike was in February 2023 to 6.50 per cent.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Signals a potential monetary policy stance reversal and end of the rate-pause period.; Directly impacts borrowing costs, retail lending rates, and overall economic growth in India.*

Static — The Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) is a statutory body constituted under Section 45ZB of the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934. The MPC is entrusted with fixing the benchmark repo rate required to contain inflation within the specified target level. The committee comprises six members: three officials of the RBI and three external members nominated by the central government.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Polity & Constitution

ptinews.com: read the source · also reported by Live Law

GS3 MAKE NOTES

India clears 58 companies for critical mineral recycling scheme to boost domestic capacity

The Ministry of Mines has approved 58 companies as eligible participants under its incentive scheme for critical mineral recycling. The initiative aims to strengthen supply security, reduce import reliance, and support clean energy and advanced manufacturing sectors. The scheme is launched under the National Critical Mineral Mission with a total financial outlay of Rs. 1,500 crore. The scheme focuses on building domestic recycling capacity for critical minerals from lithium-ion batteries, e-waste, and industrial scrap. The application window remained open until April 1, 2026, and proposals were evaluated by the Jawaharlal Nehru Aluminium Research Development and Design Centre. The Executive Committee cleared 20 entities in March and 38 entities in April, totaling 58 approved companies. The selected firms have pledged a combined recycling capacity of around 850 kilo tonnes per annum and an investment of nearly Rs. 5,000 crore. The next phase of the scheme will focus on project execution, providing financial support based on capacity development and operations.

When: October 2025 to April 2026 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Ministry of Mines, Jawaharlal Nehru Aluminium Research Development and Design Centre, 58 approved companies · **Prelims:** Total outlay of the critical mineral recycling scheme is Rs. 1,500 crore.; The scheme was notified in October 2025.; Jawaharlal Nehru Aluminium Research Development and Design Centre acted as the Project Management Agency.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reduces India's vulnerability to global supply chain shocks and import dependencies for critical minerals.; Supports the growth of domestic clean energy, electric vehicle manufacturing, and advanced electronics sectors.*

Static — Critical minerals are metallic or non-metallic elements that are essential for the economic well-being of a nation and whose supply chain is vulnerable to disruption. They are vital for clean energy technologies, electric vehicles, wind turbines, solar panels, and advanced electronics and defense equipment. India heavily relies on imports for several critical minerals such as lithium, cobalt, nickel, and rare earth elements from countries like China, Australia, and Chile.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Governance & Policy, Geography · Prelims angle: Scheme

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

Agriculture & Allied

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Examine the potential of India’s oilseed sector to reduce edible-oil import dependence. What structural constraints limit domestic production? Suggest measures for achieving sustainable self-reliance.

India has a sizeable and diversified oilseed production base but continues to depend significantly on imported edible oils. Global price, climate, and geopolitical shocks make strengthening domestic oilseed production crucial for food security and agricultural resilience. The potential of the oilseed sector lies in productivity enhancement, crop diversification, utilizing additional oil-bearing sources, and expanding into suitable agro-climatic regions. Structural constraints include production-side, climatic, technological, price-incentive, and value-chain bottlenecks that limit domestic edible-oil availability. Achieving sustainable self-reliance requires a productivity-led and resource-efficient strategy integrating improved technology, farmer incentives, processing, and market linkages. Targeted government interventions are essential to bridge the gap between domestic production capacity and import dependence. Strategic self-reliance should be prioritized over complete autarky, balancing higher domestic production with sustainability and resilience against external shocks.

When: 2026-10-06 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Farmers, Policymakers · **Prelims:** India maintains a high dependence on edible-oil imports.; The oilseed sector offers scope through productivity enhancement and crop diversification.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reduces heavy foreign exchange outflow caused by massive edible-oil imports.; Enhances farmers' income and agricultural resilience through crop diversification.*

Static — India is one of the largest oilseed growers and importers of edible oils in the world. Major oilseed crops grown in India include groundnut, mustard, soybean, sunflower, sesame, safflower, and niger. A significant portion of India's domestic edible-oil demand is met through imports of palm, soybean, and sunflower oils from countries like Indonesia, Malaysia, Argentina, and Brazil.

Syllabus: GS3: Agriculture & Allied, Economy

Insights on India: read the source

Environment & Ecology

GS3 MAKE NOTES

India calls for equal attention to Adaptation, Mitigation and Means of Implementation at Pre-COP31

Union Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav addressed the leaders' plenary in Fiji during the pre-COP31 meetings. Yadav called for equal attention to adaptation, mitigation, and means of implementation ahead of COP31. He emphasized that the key principles of CBDR-RC must be upheld in letter and spirit. CBDR-RC stands for Common but Differentiated Responsibilities and Respective Capabilities, acknowledging shared obligations but differing responsibilities. The minister stressed that there cannot be a one-size-fits-all pathway to climate action. He highlighted the importance of local studies and assessments for finding region-specific climate solutions. India offered to share its expertise in ocean science, space applications, and coastal management with Pacific island partners.

When: 2026-10-06 · **Where:** Fiji · **Who:** Union Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav · **Prelims:** COP31 is scheduled to be held in November in Antalya, Türkiye.; The pre-COP31 meetings were co-hosted by Australia, Fiji, and Tuvalu.; CBDR-RC stands for Common but Differentiated Responsibilities and Respective Capabilities.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reinforces India's steadfast commitment to climate equity and the CBDR-RC principle in international climate negotiations.; Highlights India's solidarity and technical cooperation with vulnerable Pacific Island nations facing severe climate risks.*

Static — The UNFCCC COP (Conference of the Parties) is the supreme decision-making body of the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change, held annually. CBDR-RC (Common but Differentiated Responsibilities and Respective Capabilities) is a foundational principle under international environmental law established at the 1992 Earth Summit in Rio de Janeiro. It differentiates between developed and developing nations, recognizing historical emissions and respective economic capacities to shoulder climate action burdens.

Syllabus: GS3: Environment & Ecology, International Relations

PIB: read the source · free copy on theprint.in · also reported by The Hindu

Science & Technology

GS3 MAKE NOTES

2026 Nobel Prize in Physics and IceCube Neutrino Detector

Francis Halzen has been awarded the 2026 Nobel Prize in Physics by the Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences. The award recognizes his decisive contributions to the IceCube Neutrino Observatory and the discovery of high-energy neutrinos of astrophysical origin. Halzen realized that glacial ice at the South Pole could be utilized to track elusive particles known as neutrinos. His vision and scientific leadership were fundamental in establishing the IceCube observatory, which spans a cubic kilometre of ice and is equipped with light sensors. Neutrinos are fundamental particles that pass through the Earth and human bodies unnoticed, only rarely interacting with atomic nuclei. Unlike other particles, high-energy neutrinos can travel across the universe to Earth without changing direction or losing energy. In 1988, Halzen first proposed detecting neutrinos at the South Pole due to the region's clear glacial ice and geological stability. The IceCube detector was completed in 2011, allowing researchers to detect cosmic neutrinos originating far beyond our solar system. The recorded neutrino interactions provide new insights into violent cosmic environments and help identify unknown cosmic phenomena.

When: 2026-10-06 · **Where:** South Pole · **Who:** Francis Halzen, Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences, Mark Pearce · **Prelims:** Francis Halzen proposed detecting neutrinos at the South Pole in 1988.; The IceCube Neutrino Observatory covers an area of one cubic kilometre.; The IceCube observatory was completed in 2011.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Opens up a new era of neutrino astronomy to study parts of the universe invisible to traditional telescopes.; Provides direct clues about cosmic accelerators that produce particles with energies higher than Earth-based laboratories.*

Static — Neutrinos are subatomic particles with a tiny mass and no electric charge, interacting very weakly with matter. Astrophysical neutrinos originate from extreme cosmic sources like active galactic nuclei, gamma-ray bursts, and supernovae. The South Pole is an ideal location for particle detectors due to its thick, clear, and stable ice sheet that acts as a natural detection medium.

Syllabus: GS3: Science & Technology · Prelims angle: Award

Hindustan Times: read the source · free copy on hindustantimes.com · also reported by The Hindu, Vajiram & Ravi

GS3 MAKE NOTES

DRDO Conducts Flight Trial of High-Altitude Platform

The Defence Research and Development Organisation successfully conducted a flight trial of an indigenously developed high-altitude platform. The experimental flight was carried out to test a lighter-than-air stratospheric system designed for long-endurance aerial surveillance and intelligence gathering. The core objective is to advance India's capabilities in stratospheric earth observation and long-endurance aerial monitoring. The experimental flight attained an altitude of 21 km above mean sea level and stayed at 20 km for over 30 minutes. The system was safely recovered, and flight performance data was analyzed following the successful descent. The high-altitude platform is being designed and developed by the Aerial Delivery Research and Development Establishment in Agra. The platform carried payloads including an inertial measurement unit, GPS receiver, onboard cameras, and an altitude control mechanism. The trial was coordinated with agencies including the Indian Air Force, DGCA, Airports Authority of India, and CEMILAC. The successful trial marks an important milestone in India's Aatmanirbhar Bharat journey for realizing a long-endurance stratospheric airship.

When: 2026-10-06 · **Where:** New Delhi / Agra · **Who:** DRDO, ADRDE, Indian Air Force, DGCA, Airports Authority of India, CEMILAC · **Prelims:** The HAPS experimental flight attained a peak altitude of 21 km above mean sea level.; The platform remained at an altitude of 20 km for more than 30 minutes.; The system is designed and developed by Aerial Delivery Research and Development Establishment, Agra.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Boosts India's indigenous aerial surveillance and intelligence gathering capabilities.; Advances the goal of Aatmanirbhar Bharat in strategic defence technologies.*

Static — The Defence Research and Development Organisation is the premier agency under the Department of Defence Research and Development in the Ministry of Defence, charged with military R&D. DRDO was formed in 1958 by the amalgamation of the Technical Development Establishment and the Directorate of Technical Development and Production with the Defence Science Organisation. The Aerial Delivery Research and Development Establishment is a specialized DRDO laboratory based in Agra that focuses on aerial delivery systems and lighter-than-air platforms.

Syllabus: GS3: Science & Technology, Defence

PIB: read the source · free copy on timesofindia.indiatimes.com · also reported by Hindustan Times, India.com, Sarkaritel.com

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PRELIMS FACTS

Concrete developments worth a quick read: exercises, pacts, Acts, approvals, schemes, species, verdicts.

DEFENCE APPOINTMENT QUICK READ

Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit appointed new Chief of Air Force, replacing Amar Preet Singh

Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit was appointed as the next Chief of the Air Staff in the substantive rank of Air Chief Marshal. The appointment was approved by the President and takes effect from the afternoon of October 31, 2026. He will succeed the outgoing Chief of Air Staff, Air Chief Marshal Amar Preet Singh, who superannuates on October 31, 2026.

Hindustan Times: source

DEFENCE AGREEMENT/MOU QUICK READ

MoD signs Rs 661 crore contract to procure BrahMos Fire Control System and Launchers for Indian Navy ships

The Ministry of Defence signed a Rs 661.50 crore contract with BrahMos Aerospace Private Limited for Indian Navy ships on October 6, 2026. The contract covers the procurement of BrahMos Fire Control Systems and launchers under the Buy (Indian-IDDM) category. The core issue focuses on enhancing India's maritime strike capabilities while promoting self-reliance and domestic defence manufacturing.

PIB: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION JUDGMENT QUICK READ

Supreme Court closes Constitution Bench reference case on legislative privilege and free speech

A seven-judge Supreme Court bench is scheduled to hear a long-pending case regarding legislative privilege versus free speech. The case stems from a 2003 Tamil Nadu assembly breach of privilege resolution that imposed a 15-day sentence on certain journalists. Senior counsel representing the Tamil Nadu assembly informed the court that the assembly withdrew the resolution in 2004.

Times of India: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY AWARD DAY/OBSERVANCE QUICK READ

PMAY-U Awards 2026

Best Performing States and UTs under Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana-Urban (PMAY-U) and PMAY-U 2.0 were felicitated during the PMAY-U Awards 2026. The awards were presented as part of the celebration event for World Habitat Day 2026. The PMAY-U Awards are national honors established to recognize top-performing states, Union Territories, and urban local bodies in housing scheme implementation.

ForumIAS: source

ECONOMY REPORT/INDEX QUICK READ

An Approach Paper on Expanding the scope and coverage for the Index of Services Production

The Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation invited public feedback on an approach paper to expand the scope of the Index of Services Production. The initiative aims to bridge gaps in the current framework by onboarding sectors like education, health, and public administration. The core issue is capturing non-market activities, core government tasks, and GST-exempt services that were previously excluded from the index.

PIB: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY SPECIES PLACE IN NEWS QUICK READ

Two cheetahs from Kuno released in MP's Veerangana Durgavati Tiger Reserve

Madhya Pradesh chief minister Mohan Yadav released two cheetahs, Vyom and Neera, in the Veerangana Durgavati Tiger Reserve (VDTR). The cheetahs were brought to VDTR in Sagar district from Kuno National Park. This marks the first time cheetahs have been introduced into the Veerangana Durgavati Tiger Reserve. Five soft release bomas were prepared in the Muhali range to allow the cheetahs to adjust gradually to their new environment.

Hindustan Times: source

SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY SCHEME QUICK READ

IndiaAI Mission Organised AIKosh University Engagement Programme at National Institute of Technology, Andhra Pradesh to Strengthen Indias AI Talent Ecosystem

The event took place at NIT Andhra Pradesh, Tadepalligudem, on October 5, 2026, as part of the IndiaAI Mission's outreach to university campuses. The IndiaAI Mission organised the AIKosh University Engagement Programme at NIT Andhra Pradesh to introduce students to national AI resources, tools, and datasets.

PIB: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY REPORT/INDEX QUICK READ

Provisional Census data to be available by March-April 2027: J&K and Ladakh Census chief

The J&K and Ladakh Census chief announced the completion timeline and Ladakh's milestone achievement. Ladakh became the first Union Territory to complete the Census exercise, with provisional data for J&K and Ladakh expected by March-April 2027. Ladakh completed entire Census exercise on October 5, first among all States and UTs; snow-bound areas of Himalayan States also completed the exercise; many people confused Census with SIR exercise, says J&K Census chief

The Hindu: source

DISASTER MANAGEMENT REPORT/INDEX QUICK READ

CM Samrat Choudhary directs officials to submit detailed report on flood damage in Bihar

Bihar Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary ordered authorities to submit a detailed report on flood damage and rehabilitation costs following severe floods. Water resources department secretary Dr Chandrashekhar Singh briefed the CM that floods occurred in two phases due to unprecedented high water levels and excessive rainfall.

Times of India: source

SOCIAL JUSTICE & WELFARE ACT/BILL/RULES APPOINTMENT QUICK READ

Shri Sudhansh Pant, Secretary, MoSJE to Administer Oath to Newly Appointed Members of DWBDNC Governing Body Tomorrow

The Secretary of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment administered the oath of office to two newly appointed members of the Governing Body of the Development and Welfare Board for De-notified, Nomadic and Semi-Nomadic Communities (DWBDNC).

PIB: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION JUDGMENT QUICK READ

Supreme Court Reserves Judgment On Pleas Against Delhi HC Verdict Diluting Mandatory Attendance...

A three-member Supreme Court bench reserved its verdict on petitions challenging a Delhi High Court verdict diluting mandatory attendance rules for law students. The controversy stems from a suo motu public interest case initiated by the Delhi High Court following the 2016 suicide of Amity Law School student Sushant Rohilla.

jagranjosh.com: source

HEALTH SCHEME QUICK READ

Delhi CM launches SOTTO HQ, expanded ANMOL scheme under 'Seva Sankalp Abhiyan'

Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and Lt Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu launched several health initiatives under the Seva Sankalp Abhiyan. The initiatives were launched during a program held at Thyagraj stadium in the presence of health minister Pankaj Singh. The incentive amount for ASHA workers was doubled from Rs 3,000 to Rs 6,000 to support 6,690 workers in Delhi.

theprint.in: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY QUICK READ

Cabinet approves five commissionerates for Bengaluru; former officers express concern

The Karnataka state cabinet approved the division of Bengaluru's unified police force into five separate commissionerates. The decision was finalized on Tuesday to manage law and order, crime prevention, and traffic congestion for a population exceeding 1.5 crore. Former senior police officers questioned whether civic structures can be replicated in policing, arguing crime and traffic do not follow municipal boundaries.

The Hindu: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AGREEMENT/MOU QUICK READ

Pakistan, Turkiye agree to deploy forces in Saudi Arabia under trilateral pact

Pakistan and Turkey agreed to swiftly deploy military forces to Saudi Arabia under the Mecca Defence Alliance. The decision was taken in response to ongoing attacks by Houthi rebel groups from Yemen targeting the Kingdom and holy sites. An emergency meeting of the Strategic Political and Defense Committee of the alliance took place in Riyadh.

Hindustan Times: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS QUICK READ

Jaishankar to undertake three-nation visit

External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar embarked on a five-day visit to Ghana, Cote d'Ivoire, and Ethiopia. The trip aims to explore ways to shore up bilateral ties in trade and investment, and infrastructure development. The Ministry of External Affairs stated the visit reflects India's commitment to deepen its partnership with Africa and the Global South.

The Hindu: source

ECONOMY REPORT/INDEX QUICK READ

India’s services sector growth hits three-month high: PMI survey

India's dominant services industry expanded at its fastest pace in three months in September. The acceleration was driven by stronger demand for financial, consumer, and digital services. Despite the monthly uptick, quarterly growth for July-September was the weakest since March 2022. HSBC's India Services Purchasing Managers' Index rose to 55.2 in September from 54.1 in August.

Economic Times: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS QUICK READ

Ghana to formally apply to join BRICS

Ghana has announced plans to formally apply for membership in the BRICS grouping to diversify its economic base. Foreign Affairs Minister Samuel Okudzeto Ablakwa disclosed the Cabinet decision during Indian External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar's visit. Ghana has reached out to India for assistance and backing with the formal BRICS application process. The announcement coincided with bilateral discussions to deepen cooperation in railways, pharmaceuticals, ICT, defence, and agriculture.

msn.com: source

INFRASTRUCTURE & ENERGY QUICK READ

Cabinet Approves Rs. 17.9 bn Traffic Management System for Delhi

The Union Cabinet gave its official approval for the project as reported by Construction World. The Union Cabinet approved a traffic management system for Delhi with an outlay of Rs. 17.9 billion.

Construction World: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY SPECIES PLACE IN NEWS QUICK READ

Karnataka wildlife: Committee to study rationalisation of tiger reserve buffer zones, rejects 4 quarry projects

The standing committee of the Karnataka State Board of Wildlife decided to form a technical committee to review the forest department's proposal to rationalise buffer zone boundaries across all tiger reserves. The proposal notes that villagers residing within these buffer zones face multiple regulations, using examples such as Bhadra and Bandipur tiger reserves.

deccanherald.com: source

SOCIAL JUSTICE & WELFARE SCHEME QUICK READ

Keralam to launch special housing scheme for homeless fisherfolk

The Keralam government is formulating a special housing scheme to provide homes to all homeless fisherfolk families in the state. Chief Minister V D Satheesan announced the initiative while inaugurating the distribution of electric scooters to women fish vendors in Thiruvananthapuram. The initiative aims to empower women fisherfolk, enhance their financial security, and promote self-reliance through targeted welfare programmes.

theprint.in: source

EDITORIAL WATCH

What the opinion pages argued: two or three lines each.

GS2 Disabled citizens and the future of AI

Artificial intelligence is rapidly entering government services, recruitment, and health care, while the Centre courts large investments without early inclusion of disabled citizens. While AI can act as a helpful tool by reading documents and describing photos, current applications often exhibit severe bias and technical errors regarding disability. In Rajive Raturi v. Union of India, the Supreme Court ruled accessibility as part of the fundamental right to life and dignity, ordering mandatory standards.

The Hindu

GS2 From India to Global South, a Gujarat water-governance model

New Delhi has hosted the ninth India International Water Week, where a new case study highlighted India's water reforms tested in Gujarat. The study titled 'From Gujarat to India: Water Lessons for the World' traces reforms from 2001 to 2026 and provides four key lessons for the Global South. The central finding emphasizes that water security is fundamentally a challenge of governance and institutional design rather than pure engineering.

civilsdaily.com

GS3 Fault lines in GDP growth

The article was published as an opinion piece in BusinessLine discussing current fault lines in GDP growth. The editorial examines the structural constraints in India's GDP growth, specifically focusing on manufacturing, real estate, employment, private investment, and consumption expenditure. Constraints in manufacturing, real estate, employment, private investment and consumption expenditure call for a fresh policy rethink

BusinessLine

GS2 Viksit Bharat demands impact assessment anchored in law for optimal regulations

It is in the news as part of policy discussions on reforming regulations to support Viksit Bharat. The editorial argues that achieving a developed nation status requires anchoring regulatory impact assessments in law to curb over-regulation.

Financial Express

GS2 Ashok Lavasa: Can the Election Commission untie knots of its own making?

The Election Commission of India (ECI) faces unprecedented public criticism and legal challenges following internal rifts and controversial decisions regarding the Special Intensive Revision (SIR). Internal friction became public when 14 letters written by two Election Commissioners revealed cracks in the organisation and pushed the Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) into a storm. The Supreme Court admitted petitions seeking the suspension of the CEC for authoritarian ways, while the Chief Justice of India reportedly noted that no modified Form 6 was approved by the court.

msn.com

GS2 The knock on the Supreme Court's door

The Election Commission of India shifted from its multi-member design to a one-man show during the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls. Supreme Court judges Justice Ujjal Bhuyan and former judge Rohinton Fali Nariman criticized the SIR for threatening the right to vote and mass disenfranchisement. The core issue is that vulnerable voters faced excessive documentary burdens and hurdles to prove eligibility, undermining the ECI's record of inclusiveness.

civilsdaily.com

GS3 Resistance to data centres is arising in India too: It's time for policy to address people's concerns

Growing local protests and public worries near proposed data centre sites have put the spotlight on community friction. Local resistance and public concerns regarding water and power consumption by data centres are emerging in India. Data centres needn't guzzle as much water and power as protestors say. But people who live in proximity of data-centre sites do have worries we can't dismiss. The government should take these into account, lest they get in the way of plans.

Mint

GS3 New FEMA can be fatale for e-shoppers

The rules came into effect on October 1, triggering immediate apprehension over individual digital service purchases. New FEMA rules effective October 1 require banks to report goods and service imports to the RBI, creating confusion and uncertainty for individual consumers purchasing international digital services and subscriptions. Banks will now need to report imports of goods and services to the RBI to improve trade data accuracy. However, there is concern that reporting for international credit card purchases may be delayed compared to machinery transactions.

Economic Times

GS2 CEC is not the Election Commission

The Supreme Court heard petitions examining reports that Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi recorded objections on at least 14 occasions against actions taken in the name of the ECI. Senior advocate Vikas Singh sought the immediate suspension of CEC Gyanesh Kumar, which the Court declined ex parte while issuing notice for a hearing. The Chief Justice observed that ECI decisions must be unanimous or decided by majority, and the Court can declare contrary actions ultra vires.

tribuneindia.com

GS3 GST reforms: commercial activity in India could be set for another major tax stimulus

An upcoming GST Council meeting scheduled for this Wednesday has put potential tax and procedural reforms in the news. The editorial discusses anticipated procedural reforms by the GST Council aimed at removing hurdles and providing a tax stimulus to commercial activity in India. Numerous procedural problems that currently get in the way of realizing the full benefits of the goods and services tax (GST) will hopefully be done away with at the GST Council meeting this Wednesday.

Mint

GS3 Rajiv Memani: How a new set of economic reforms could help India's economy stay resilient amid global turmoil

The article appeared in Mint on October 6, 2026, discussing strategies for India's economic resilience amidst global turmoil. An editorial advocating for a new set of priority economic reforms to enhance India's economic competitiveness, growth, and job creation amid global uncertainty. The Indian economy has shown remarkable resilience in the face of global flux. Here's a list of reforms that demand priority.

Mint

GS2 Courts must protect, not regulate free speech

It is in the news due to ongoing debates and concerns regarding potential attempts to regulate freedom of speech and expression. An editorial discussing how courts must prioritize the protection of free speech rather than attempting to regulate or restrict it further. Any attempt at further regulating the right to freedom of speech and expression must be scrutinised, especially when it comes from the top court

The Hindu

GS2 Building anganwadis as an act of care

Architect Swati Janu argues that the physical spaces built for young children significantly shape their early learning and development. India operates over a million anganwadis under the Integrated Child Development Services programme launched in 1975. Most government rooms are built for adults, but Janu designs spaces specifically addressing the world below three feet. Low-cost interventions include outward-facing bookshelves, blackboard paint walls, tactile boards, and beaded grills acting as counting frames.

Hindustan Times

GS2 Peaceful dissent is a constitutional right

It appeared as an opinion piece in The Hindu focusing on the protection of peaceful dissent. The editorial discusses peaceful dissent as an essential constitutional right and an expression of faith in the democratic republic. It must be recognised as an expression of faith in the Constitution and in the democratic promise of the Republic

The Hindu

GS1 Punjab's culture thekedaars have found their easiest targets—Influencers

Madhusudan, known as Mad Sandhu, an LGBT make-up artist and influencer, was shot dead by two motorcycle-riding assailants in Amritsar on 3 October. Sandhu's murder highlights a worrying trend where self-appointed cultural guardians in Punjab target vulnerable social media influencers over content and identity. The core issue is the rise of moral policing by radical outfits and self-styled wardens who attack content creators, particularly women and gender minorities, under the guise of preserving culture.

ThePrint

EXPLAINED

The concept behind the news, one or two lines each.

Why are States divided over the mining amendment? The mining amendment shifts taxing room from mineral-rich States to the Union, creating recurring Centre-State friction. Parliament is attempting through ordinary law what the Supreme Court's reading of the State List previously ruled out. Cancelling dues already levied causes retrospective loss and unsettles State budgets planned around those revenues.

The Hindu

Why is Buxa bringing tigers back? Buxa Tiger Reserve in West Bengal is undertaking tiger reintroduction to restore a self-sustaining tiger population in its suitable habitat. A recent assessment revealed that there were no resident tigers left in Buxa, necessitating the reintroduction initiative. A three-year-old tigress named T138 was translocated and released into Buxa from the Valmiki Tiger Reserve in Bihar.

ForumIAS

India's Rising Supercomputing Ecosystem India started building indigenous supercomputers with the PARAM 8000 in the early 1990s and has since expanded through the National Supercomputing Mission launched in 2015. The topic is in the news as the Council of Scientific & Industrial Research is holding the Emerging Science, Technology and Innovation Conclave from October 27 to 29, 2026.

ForumIAS

Who modified what?: Supreme Court seeks ECI records on Form 6 change The Supreme Court stated it never approved any modifications to Form 6, the statutory application for new voter registration. The controversy focuses on additional ancestry-related declarations introduced on the online ECINET portal during the Special Intensive Revision. Petitioners and dissenting Election Commissioners argued that altering statutory forms requires amending the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960.

outlookindia.com

Jaishankar says UN 'largely irrelevant', UNSC 'gridlocked': Why India pushes for reform External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar called the United Nations largely irrelevant in decision-making on major global crises due to a gridlocked UN Security Council. Speaking at the 5th Kautilya Economic Conclave in New Delhi, he stated that the UN failed to respond effectively to conflicts in the Gulf, Ukraine, Africa, and the Covid-19 pandemic.
msn.com

What the 2026 Physics Nobel winner has done: Capturing messengers from space in ice It appeared as an explainer in the Indian Express. The provided text is an explainer headline regarding the 2026 Physics Nobel winner capturing messengers from space in ice.
Indian Express

From 'We Won't Fight' To Troops For Saudi Arabia: Pakistan's Yemen U-Turn And The Mecca Pact Pakistan, Saudi Arabia, and Türkiye agreed to move towards the rapid deployment of military forces to Saudi Arabia under the Mecca Joint Defence Agreement. The agreement follows Saudi-backed Yemeni forces launching a major push against Iran-aligned Houthi fighters near the Bab el-Mandeb Strait.
news18.com

Mint Explainer | Why the RBI looks set to hike rates Rising inflation, higher oil prices and global monetary tightening have put pressure on the central bank. The RBI is widely expected to hike the repo rate due to multiple macroeconomic pressures.
Mint

The Mecca Pact has been activated by Saudi Arabia, Turkey and Pakistan. Why now? The Mecca Pact was activated on Monday following an emergency meeting of the Strategic-Political and Defense Committee in Riyadh. Pakistan and Turkey agreed to move towards the rapid deployment of troops and military capabilities to Saudi Arabia.
indiatoday.in

Rewilding great Indian bustards: The project and the challenges ahead The initiative is in the news due to ongoing conservation measures and debates surrounding habitat protection and infrastructural threats. This explainer details the ongoing conservation and rewilding efforts for the critically endangered great Indian bustard, highlighting the strategies and major hurdles involved.
Indian Express

Pakistan, Turkey say 'military forces' will help Saudi Arabia. Why this may not mean troops in active combat The announcement regarding military assistance to Saudi Arabia by Pakistan and Turkey put the topic in the news. Pakistan and Turkey have announced that their military forces will help Saudi Arabia, though analysts note this may not involve active combat troops.
Indian Express

Knowledge Nugget | How should you read Maharashtra's drought It was published as a Knowledge Nugget by The Indian Express for UPSC current affairs preparation. An explainer on how UPSC aspirants should analyze the recurring phenomenon of droughts in Maharashtra.
Indian Express

Francis Halzen wins 2026 Nobel Prize in Physics: What are neutrinos, aka ghost particles he studied? Francis Halzen won the 2026 Nobel Prize in Physics for his ground-breaking work creating an observatory to detect high-energy neutrinos. The trigger for the award is his realization that ice at the South Pole could be used to track elusive neutrinos.
msn.com

Explainer: Why have India-US trade talks stalled again and what's next? Long-running efforts to finalise a bilateral trade agreement between India and the United States have stalled again. Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman stated trade talks have reached a plateau with little room for manoeuvre.
Economic Times

Explainer: Why the Election Commission's Form 6 for new voters has triggered a legal row The Supreme Court clarified that it had not approved any modified version of Form 6 used for new voter registrations. The controversy arose after petitions sought the suspension of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over unilateral procedural decisions during the special intensive revision of electoral rolls.
scroll.in

G7 to release 100 million barrels of oil, diesel: Will this bring prices under control? The decision comes in response to sharp spikes in global oil and diesel prices caused by acute supply disruptions. The G7 has announced a coordinated release of 100 million barrels of crude oil and diesel from strategic reserves to cool soaring global energy prices.
Indian Express

Scientists found 57 species unknown to science. Why the deep ocean remains a mystery Scientists examining samples from a deep-sea canyon off Argentina identified 57 species previously unknown to science and five new genera within two weeks. The specimens were collected during a 2025 expedition to the Mar del Plata Submarine Canyon and examined at a workshop in Buenos Aires.
theprint.in

Protests against Gyanesh Kumar: What was the 2006 Keralam corruption case that led to his removal from post? Recent protests and public discussions brought the 2006 Keralam corruption case and Gyanesh Kumar back into focus. This explainer details the protests against Gyanesh Kumar and the context of the 2006 Keralam corruption case linked to his past removal.
Indian Express

Harness engineering is how AI developers are now trying to make agents work reliably It is in the news because AI agents are becoming significantly more capable in 2026, requiring new structural methods to keep them on track. Harness engineering is a methodology used by AI developers to build supporting systems around AI models, ensuring agents work reliably, stay within boundaries, and remain accountable.
The Hindu

ALSO IN THE NEWS

Reactions, previews and smaller stories: one line each.

- Ganga Water Treaty is ‘flawed’, needs to be updated: Bangladesh river expert (International Relations) The Hindu
- Pakistan successfully test-fires extended version of Fatah-4 cruise missile (International Relations) Economic Times
- Indo-Swiss Research Framework to Give Fresh Impetus to Two Decades of Scientific Cooperation and Open New Avenues for Joint Research and Innovation: Dr. Jitendra Singh (Science & Technology) PIB
- 11 Indian crew injured after ship hit by projectile in Strait of Hormuz; India condemns attack (International Relations) The Hindu
- The Election Commission must show who decided (Polity & Constitution) Frontline
- CAQM mandates Installation of PTZ Cameras at Industries to ensure Comprehensive Real-time Monitoring of Fuel Use and Compliance in NCR (Environment & Ecology) PIB
- Forest Rights Act under pressure in Madhya Pradesh (Environment & Ecology) Frontline
- Jammu and Kashmir: High court quashes PSA detention of Shopian man for ‘showing anti-national tendencies’ (Polity & Constitution) Times of India
- Anti-ragging guidelines drawn up, State informs Kerala HC (Social Justice & Welfare) The Hindu
- Chintan Shivir 2026 Concludes with Focus on Collaborative Knowledge Sharing for Quality Road Infrastructure (Infrastructure & Energy) PIB
- The IUCN Red List of Ecosystems (Environment & Ecology) International Union for Conservation of Nature
- Tarang Shakti: Over 25 IAF women officers fly in largest-ever international exercise (Defence) Hindustan Times
- Russia proposes restoring cooperation with Afghanistan through SCO (International Relations) Anadolu Ajans
- ‘Deleted voter filing Form 6 not false declaration’: Election Commission tells Bombay High Court amid SIR row (Polity & Constitution) Hindustan Times
- E-Sanjeevani Crosses 50 Crore Teleconsultations, Strengthening Access to Healthcare Across the Country (Health) PIB
- IIT Ropar launches digital learning initiative to build agri awareness among children (Education) BusinessLine
- Kaziranga National Park in Assam reopens for 2026-27 season: Jeep safaris begin, elephant rides to return (Environment & Ecology) The Times of India
- India concludes 16th BRICS Trade Ministers’ Meeting in Jaipur with focus on WTO reforms, MSMEs and resilient supply chains (International Relations) DD News
- Supreme Court Upholds Recovery Of Excess Pay From NIT Calicut Teachers Who Gave Written Undertakings (Polity & Constitution) LawChakra
- AAI Signs MoU with West Bengal for New Airports and Civil Enclaves (Infrastructure & Energy) PSU Connect
- UP makes its mark across the country under PM Awas Yojana-Urban, honored with two national awards (Governance & Policy) Prokerala
- President Appoints 3 Chief Justices as Supreme Court Judges (Polity & Constitution) SCC Online
- Could this rare tarantula "go extinct" sooner than expected? Here’s what IUCN says about... (Environment & Ecology) Moneycontrol.com
- Jongsong Peak, Location, Height, Geography, Significance (Geography) Vajiram & Ravi
- BRICS Melody Comes to Jaipur: First International Cultural Project to Open Citys 300th Anniversary Year (History, Art & Culture) The Tribune
- Need to have multiple routes under IMEC: French Special envoy (International Relations) Economic Times
- National Commission for Women seeks gender-neutral childcare leave, shared caregiving by parents (Social Justice & Welfare) Times of India
- Distinguish between transparency and accountability. How do they reinforce ethical governance? (Ethics & Integrity) Insights on India
- Can party symbol be given to those accused of committing 'constitutional sin' of defection: Supreme Court (Polity & Constitution) The Hindu
- Single-window GST registration for multistate businesses set for pilot this week (Economy) Economic Times
- How DRDO's Latest 1,200-Second Scramjet Test Success Could Transform India's Missile Power (Defence) Indianmasterminds
- Criminal case can’t be strong-arm tactic to force marriage: Supreme Court (Polity & Constitution) Hindustan Times
- PM Modi says Cabinet decision gives major boost to MSME sector (Economy) All India Radio (NewsOnAir)
- ‘UN has become largely irrelevant’: Jaishankar calls for Security Council reform (International Relations) Deccan Herald

- The Western Ghats ESA: Why A Scientific Consensus is Stuck in Political Deadlock (Environment & Ecology) Observer Research Foundation
- Bhutan, India Boost Clean Energy Ties With 770 Megawatt Hydropower Deal (International Relations) NDTV
- Navy staff among 2 arrested in Andhra Pradesh for sharing sensitive defence information with Pakistan: 'Shared OTP, communicated with them' (Internal Security) Hindustan Times
- Defence Minister Rajnath Singh pitches indigenous aero-engine capability for AMCA (Defence) The Hindu
- Naval staffer among two arrested for spying for Pakistan: Andhra Police (Internal Security) Economic Times
- I4C, RBIH join hands to use AI against mule accounts and cyber frauds (Economy) DD News
- Two arrested; 13 Navy personnel among 18 under scanner for alleged leaks to Pakistan intelligence operatives (Internal Security) The Hindu
- Raksha Mantri launches first indigenous Fleet Support Ship 'INS Surya' at Hindustan Shipyard Ltd in Visakhapatnam (Defence) PIB
- Government Notifies National Tribunals Commission Rules, 2026; New Framework Introduced for Tribunal Appointments, Merit-Based Selection, Pay, Accountability and National Tribunals Data Grid (Polity & Constitution) A2Z Taxcorp LLP
- India-Switzerland Relations: Trade, Investment & Cooperation (International Relations) NEXT IAS
- India sizes up US F-35 stealth jets in landmark first on home turf (Defence) South China Morning Post

COVERAGE CHECK

Items — 17 must-know, 20 Prelims facts, 45 in the news, 15 editorials, 19 explainers.

Syllabus areas in the cards — Economy (9), Governance & Policy (5), Polity & Constitution (4), International Relations (4), Science & Technology (3), Environment & Ecology (3), Health (2), Defence (2), Social Justice & Welfare (2), Agriculture & Allied (1), Disaster Management (1), Infrastructure & Energy (1). **Nothing today in —** Education, Internal Security, History, Art & Culture, Geography, Society, Ethics & Integrity.

Easy-miss watch — Marine & coastal (EEZ, UNCLOS, Blue Economy, deep sea): 3 · Digital Public Infrastructure & data governance: nothing today · Political change in the neighbourhood: 2 · Appointments to constitutional / statutory / regulatory bodies: 2 · Defence-technology cooperation agreements: 2

Full text — 51 of 71 items were read in full from a free copy; the rest are summarised from the outlets' reports. Subscriber-only sites are never opened.

Sources in the cards — The Hindu 11, PIB 7, Indian Express 6, Economic Times 5, Hindustan Times 5, msn.com 4, Mint 4, ForumIAS 3, theprint.in 3, Business Standard 2, BusinessLine 2, ptinews.com 2, Times of India 2, civilsdaily.com 2

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